MODULE 4 · HANDS-ON WORKSHOP · 90 MINUTES

Stop Chasing, Start Flowing



Automating everyday Takaful routines with Microsoft Teams Workflows

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What you will walk out with today



A working workflow

You build it yourself: a request form that alerts your team and asks a manager for approval — inside Teams.



A blueprint for YOUR job

One routine task from your own department, written as WHEN → IF → DO, ready to build next week.



An eye for automation

A 4-question test to spot which of your daily tasks are worth automating — and which are not.

No coding. No theory marathon. Over 60% of today is hands-on, in pairs.

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Our 90 minutes



Hook	Idea + case	Hands-on labs	Your routine	Closing
Cost of small tasks	WHEN → IF → DO, Referral Desk	Build it in pairs: Lab 1 → 2 → 3	Automation Canvas	Q&A

Sit with someone from a different department. One of you will be the requester, the other the manager who approves. You will see how the same workflow serves both sides.

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PART 1

The hidden cost of “just a quick task”

Before any tool: let’s count the chasing we already do

Hands up if you did this last week…



Copied details from a form or email into Excel or another email



Chased a manager for an approval on WhatsApp or by phone



Forwarded the same document to three different people



Sent the same reminder message every week



Kept opening a folder to check whether a file had arrived



Asked “any update on my request?” — more than once

Every one of these can be handled by a workflow.

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Small tasks quietly add up

15 min

a day on chasing,
copying and reminding

× 250

working days
in a year

≈ 8 days

of your year —
per person

A 50-person department
loses more than 400 working days a year to tasks nobody enjoys.

Your number:
_____ min/day × 250 ÷ 60 = _____ hours/year

15 min × 250 days = 62.5 hours ≈ 8.3 working days (7.5-hour day).

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PART 2

One idea: WHEN → IF → DO

The only theory you need today

Every workflow is one sentence

WHEN

something happens

In Workflows it is called: Trigger

Example: …a customer service form is submitted

IF

a rule is true (optional)

In Workflows it is called: Condition

Example: …the claim amount is RM 20,000 or above

DO

this automatically

In Workflows it is called: Action

Example: …ask the manager to approve in Teams, then post the result

WHEN a request form is submitted, **IF** it is RM 20,000 or above, **DO** send it to the manager for approval.

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Is it worth automating? The 4-question test

1. Does it happen at least every week?
2. Does it follow the same rule every time?
3. Does it start from something digital — a form, email, file or a time?
4. Does it happen in Microsoft 365 — Teams, Outlook, Forms, SharePoint, Planner, Excel?

4 × YES → a great first workflow.

Keep the judgement human

Underwriting decisions, claim assessments and customer conversations need people.

Automate the chasing around them: the hand-offs, reminders, alerts and status updates.

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PART 3 · CASE STUDY

The Referral Desk

How one claims executive stopped chasing approvals (a fictional but familiar story)

Before: Nadia’s Monday

Nadia is a claims executive. Agents send her requests; big claims need her manager’s approval.

1. 

   Agent emails a request

2. 

   Nadia checks the shared inbox 5× a day

3. 

   Copies details into an Excel tracker

4. 

   WhatsApps her manager for big claims

5. 

   Manager replies 2 days later: “Which one?”

6. 

   Nadia emails the agent the outcome

3 days

average wait for an approval

4 tools

email, Excel, WhatsApp, phone

0

visibility — nobody knows the status

Illustrative scenario for training purposes.

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After: the Referral Desk workflow

WHEN

Agent submits the Referral Desk form

DO

Request is posted in the team channel automatically

IF

Amount band is RM 20,000 or above?

DO

Manager gets an Approve / Reject card in Teams

DO

Decision is posted; everyone sees the status

6 → 2

manual hand-offs

4 → 1

tool: everything in Teams

Minutes

not days, for most approvals

Nadia now spends her time assessing claims — not chasing them. This is exactly what you will build next.

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Same pattern, every department

HR

WHEN a new-joiner form is submitted

DO post the onboarding checklist to the HR channel

IT

WHEN a helpdesk form is marked Urgent

DO alert the on-duty support channel

Underwriting

WHEN a case is above the auto-acceptance limit

DO send a referral to a senior underwriter to approve

Claims

WHEN claim documents are uploaded to SharePoint

DO notify the claims team channel

Finance

WHEN a payment request is submitted

DO ask the budget owner to approve in Teams

Customer Service

WHEN a complaint is tagged Escalate

DO alert the supervisor and log it in Excel

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PART 4 · HANDS-ON · 40 MINUTES

Build the Referral Desk

In pairs: Partner A = requester, Partner B = manager. Swap roles after Lab 3.

Set-up check (2 minutes)

- Teams is open and signed in with your PRU BSN account
- You can open team “PRU BSN AI Training” → channel “Sandbox” (a standard channel, not private)
- Microsoft Forms opens at forms.office.com
- You can find the Workflows app: ••• (More apps) → search “Workflows” (it used to be called Power Automate)
- You know your partner’s work email address (needed in Lab 3)

Fictional data only

Use made-up names like “Ali Test”.

Never enter real customer names, NRIC, policy numbers, medical or bank details — messages are visible to the whole channel.

Stuck at any check? Raise your hand now, not in Lab 2.

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Three labs, one workflow — each adds a layer

LAB 1

15 min ★☆☆

WHEN form submitted → DO post in channel

Everyone finishes this

LAB 2

10 min ★★☆

+ IF amount band is RM 20,000+ → urgent alert

Most people finish this

LAB 3

15 min ★★★

+ DO approval to your partner → post decision

The full Referral Desk



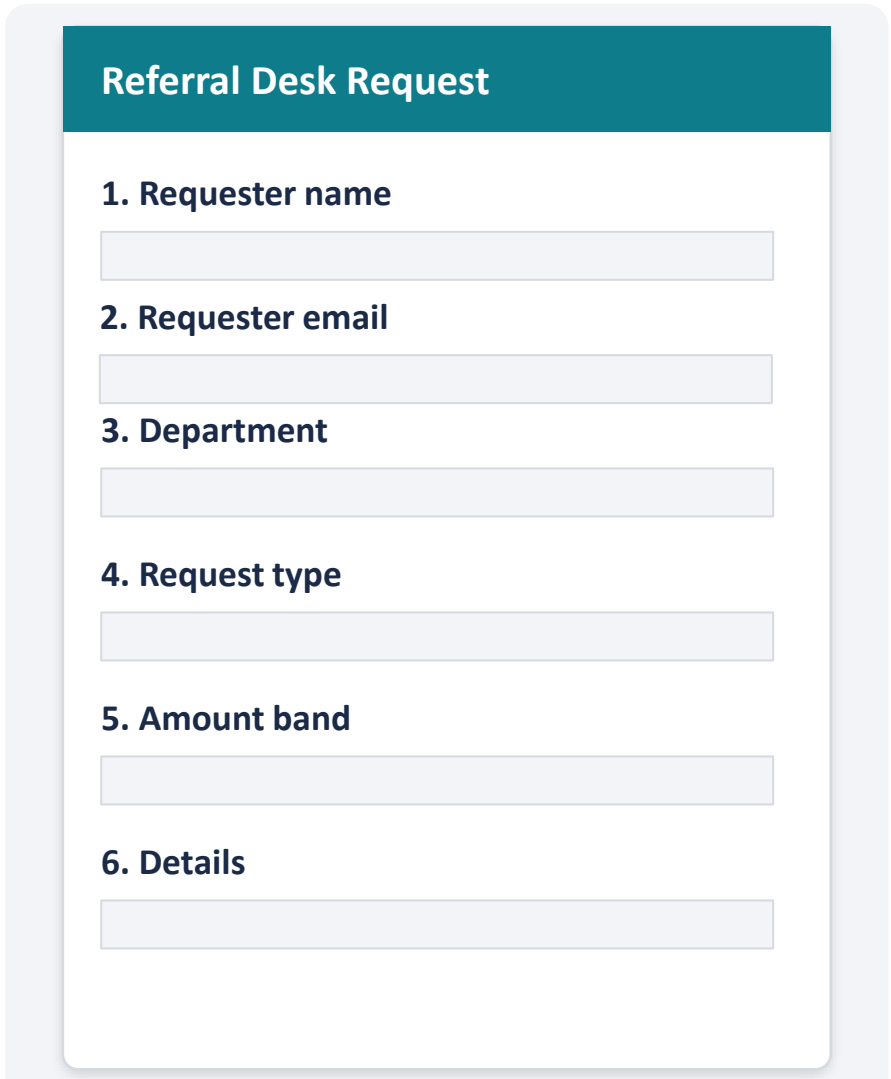
Finished early?

Try a stretch challenge, or help a neighbour. Helping is the fastest way to learn.

You build on the same workflow each time — you never start over.

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Lab 1a · Create the request form (5 min)

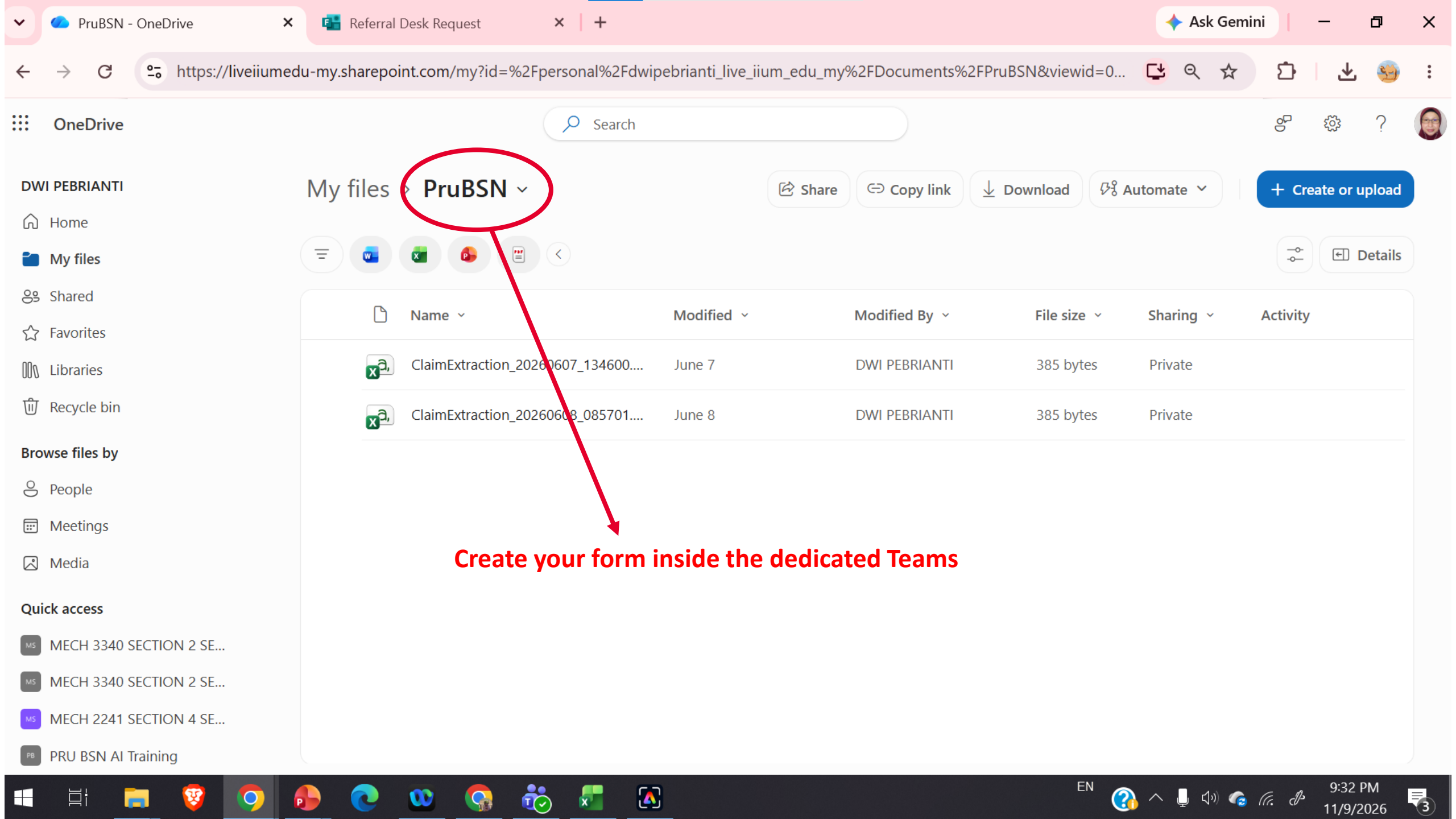


#	Question	Type and options
1	Requester name	Text
2	Requester email	Text
3	Department	Choice: Claims · Underwriting · HR · IT · Finance · Customer Service
4	Request type	Choice: Claim document · Policy change · Payment approval · Access request
5	Amount band	Choice: Below RM 20,000 · RM 20,000 and above
6	Details	Text (long answer)

Steps: forms.office.com → New Form → name it “Referral Desk Request” → add the 5 questions → Collect responses → copy the link and send it to your partner in Teams chat.
Tip: make “Amount band” a Choice question — the exact wording matters in Lab 2.

Referral Desk Request – Fill out form

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PruBSN - OneDrive
Referral Desk Request
Ask Gemini
https://liveiiumedu-my.sharepoint.com/my?id=%2Fpersonal%2Fdwipebrianti_live_iium_edu_my%2FDocuments%2FPruBSN&viewid=0...
OneDrive
Search
DWI PEBRIANTI
Home
My files
Shared
Favorites
Libraries
Recycle bin
Browse files by
People
Meetings
Media
Quick access
MECH 3340 SECTION 2 SE...
MECH 3340 SECTION 2 SE...
MECH 2241 SECTION 4 SE...
PRU BSN AI Training
My files
PruBSN
Share
Copy link
Download
Automate
Create or upload
Details
Name
Modified
Modified By
File size
Sharing
Activity
ClaimExtraction_20260607_134600....
June 7
DWI PEBRIANTI
385 bytes
Private
ClaimExtraction_20260608_085701....
June 8
DWI PEBRIANTI
385 bytes
Private
Create your form inside the dedicated Teams
EN
9:32 PM
11/9/2026

Lab 1b · Build the flow (10 min)

1. Workflows → **+ Build from scratch** → Choose what starts this → **Build with Power Automate to see more triggers** (opens in your browser).
2. Name it “Referral Desk – your name” → search **Forms** → **When a new response is submitted** → Create → choose your form.
3. Add action **Microsoft Forms – Get response details** → same form → Response Id = ⚡ Response Id.
4. DO: **Microsoft Teams – Post message in a chat or channel** → Post as: Flow bot · Post in: Channel · Team: PRU BSN AI Training · Channel: Sandbox.
5. Message: type text and insert answers with ⚡ dynamic content (see right).
6. **Save** → Partner A submits the form → wait 1–3 minutes → check Sandbox.



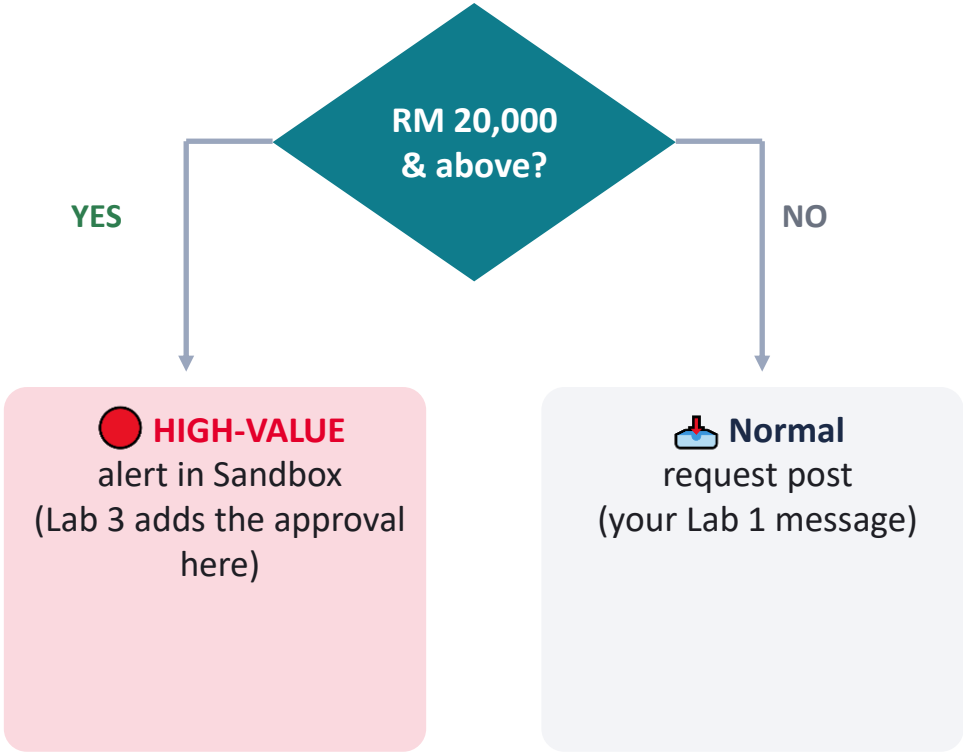
Message example

📥 New request from **[Requester name]** (**[Department]**) – **[Request type]**, **[Amount band]**. Details: **[Details]**

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Lab 2 · Add a decision: IF (10 min)

1. Hover between **Get response details** and the post → + → **Control – Condition**
2. Set: **[Amount band] is equal to RM 20,000 and above**
3. Move your existing post into the **False / No** branch (normal request).
4. In the **True / Yes** branch add a new post: "🔴 HIGH-VALUE request from **[Requester name]** – needs senior review"
5. **Save and test twice** — once with each amount band.

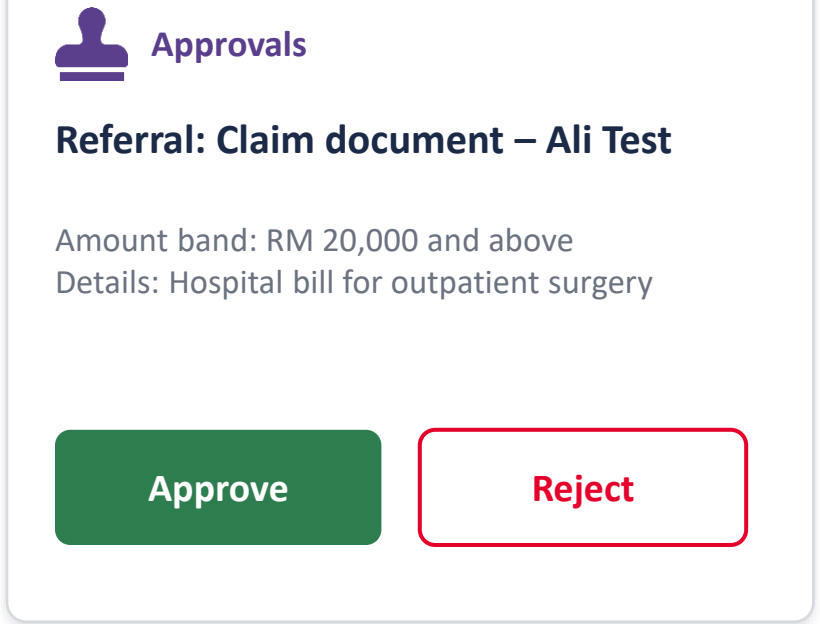


Common mistake: the text must match the form choice exactly — spaces, commas, capitals.

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Lab 3 · Add the approval (15 min)

1. In the **Yes** branch, before the red post: + → **Approvals – Start and wait for an approval**
2. Type: **Approve/Reject – First to respond** · Title: Referral: **[Request type]** – **[Requester name]**
3. Assigned to: **your partner's work email** · Details: **[Details]**
4. Add a **Condition**: **[Outcome]** is equal to **Approve**
5. Yes → post "✅ Approved by **[Responder name]**" · No → post "❌ Rejected: **[Comments]**"
6. **Test:** A submits an RM 20,000+ request → B approves in Teams (Activity or the Approvals app) → check Sandbox.



What Partner B sees in Teams

This replaces the WhatsApp chase. The request, the decision and who decided are all recorded.

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It didn’t work? Check these first

Nothing posted after 1 minute

Wait up to 3 minutes. Then open the flow → Run history.

Run history shows a red ✗

Click the failed step — it tells you exactly what went wrong.

Sandbox is not in the channel list

Workflows cannot post to private channels — use a standard channel.

The message has no answers in it

You skipped “Get response details”. Add it before the post.

The condition always goes to No

The choice text does not match exactly. Copy it from the form.

Asked to “Sign in” or “Add connection”

Normal on first use. Click it once and allow access.

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PART 5 · 15 MINUTES

Now automate YOUR routine

The labs were practice. This is the workflow that will save you time next week.

Automation Canvas

MY ROUTINE TASK

What do I do, and how often?

WHEN

What starts it? (form, email, file, time…)

IF

Any rule or decision? (optional)

DO

What should happen automatically?

WHO BENEFITS?

Me, my team, my manager, the customer…

TIME SAVED

_____ *minutes per week*

DATA CHECK

Any customer or personal data? Where will it be posted?

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Automate responsibly — the Takaful way

Test with fictional data

Never use real customer cases while building or testing.

Keep sensitive data out of channels

No NRIC, medical, bank or policy details in Teams posts.

Add a co-owner

So the flow keeps running when you are on leave or change roles.

Name it clearly

[Department] – [What it does] – [Owner], e.g. Claims – Referral approval – Nadia

It runs as you

A workflow uses your access rights. Only automate what you are allowed to do.

Ask IT before going wider

Company data policies may block some connectors — that is protection, not a bug.

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Three things to remember

1 **Think in one sentence**

WHEN something happens, IF a rule is true, DO this.

2 **Automate the chasing**

Keep the judgement human. Remove the reminders, copying and hand-offs around it.

3 **Start small, this week**

One routine. One workflow. Then the next takes 10 minutes.

Your first workflow is the hardest. You have already built it.

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THANK YOU

Questions?



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